

Recruitment message

Recruitment Message

Hi! 🙋

We are a team of 5 ALU students working on our final project. We are conducting a short research study about healthcare access for international students and newcomers in Rwanda.

We are interested in understanding how people find pharmacies that accept their insurance and how they access healthcare when they need it.

We are looking for people who:

- Arrived in Rwanda within the last 2 years
- Are international students or other newcomers
- Are pharmacists or pharmacy staff
- Work at an insurance company, hospital, or clinic

The interview takes about 20 minutes and can be done through WhatsApp, Google Meet, or in person.

There are no right or wrong answers. This is not a sales pitch. We simply want to hear about your real experiences.

Your participation is voluntary, and your responses will be kept anonymous for our academic research.

If you are interested, please reply here or DM me. Thank you! 🙏

Participant Consent Form

Participant Consent Form

Research Topic

Healthcare Access for International Students and Newcomers in Rwanda

Purpose of the Interview

We are a team of African Leadership University students conducting user research to understand how international students and newcomers access pharmacies, hospitals, insurance services, and emergency healthcare in Rwanda.

The interview will take approximately 20 minutes.

Voluntary Participation

Your participation is completely voluntary. You may choose not to answer any question, and you may stop the interview at any time.

Confidentiality

Your responses will be used for academic research and project development. We will not intentionally identify you by name in our final project materials.

Recording

With your permission, the interview may be audio recorded so that the research team can accurately capture what you said.

The recording will be used only for this academic project.

Consent

Please confirm the following:

- ☐ I understand the purpose of this interview.
- ☐ I understand that participation is voluntary.
- ☐ I understand that I may skip questions or stop the interview at any time.
- ☐ I agree to participate in the interview.
- ☐ I agree to have the interview audio recorded.

Participant name: _____

Participant category: _____

Date: _____

Interviewer: _____

Participant confirmation: _____

★ Interview Script (Local Students)

Healthcare Access User Interview Script (Local Students)

Target Audience: Rwandan local students

Focus: Real past experiences, habits, challenges with local healthcare systems, insurance, late-night/24-hour pharmacies, and emergency services.

Opening 2

- "Hello, thank you for taking the time to speak with us."
- "We are conducting research for our African Leadership University project. We want to understand students' actual, real-life experiences accessing healthcare, pharmacies, insurance, and emergency services in Rwanda."
- "There are no right or wrong answers, and we are not selling or pitching any product. We only want to learn from your real experiences."
- "Before we begin, do you agree to participate in this interview?"
- "Do you also agree to have this interview audio recorded strictly for our academic research?"
- "Thank you. Let's begin."

Section 1: Background & General Experience

- "Can you briefly tell me about yourself and what you are studying?"
- "What type of health insurance do you currently use (e.g., Mutuelle de Santé, RSSB/RAMA, MMI, private insurance, or none)?"
- "Can you walk me through the last time you needed to visit a clinic, hospital, or pharmacy?" 2

Section 2: Navigating Healthcare & Insurance Coverage — 5 minutes

- "When you feel unwell, how do you usually decide where to go or what clinic/hospital to visit first?" 1
- "How do you check beforehand whether a specific pharmacy or clinic accepts your particular insurance?"
- "Can you describe a time when you went to a pharmacy or healthcare facility, only to find out your insurance was not accepted or didn't cover a specific medicine?"

- "What did you end up doing in that situation?"
- "What information do you feel is hardest to find before you physically visit a clinic or pharmacy?"

Section 3: Emergency Situations & Preparedness

- "If you or a classmate had a sudden medical emergency on or off campus, what exact steps would you take first?"
- "Which emergency contact or ambulance service number would you call?" 3
- "How did you learn about that number or emergency contact?"
- "Have you ever experienced or witnessed a medical emergency in Rwanda? If yes, can you walk me through what happened?"
- "What was the most challenging part of getting immediate help during that situation?"

Section 4: Finding Open & Duty Pharmacies (Garde)

- "How do you usually find out which pharmacy is open near you, especially during evenings, weekends, or holidays?"
- "Have you ever needed medicine late at night or outside regular business hours? Tell me about that experience."
- "How do you currently check which pharmacies are on duty (*pharmacie de garde*) in your area?"
- "What issues, if any, have you faced when trying to locate an open pharmacy at night?"

Section 5: Closing

- "Looking back at your experiences as a student, what is the single biggest frustration or challenge you face when trying to get healthcare or medicine?"
- "If you could improve one part of how healthcare or pharmacy information is shared with local students, what would it be?" 4
- "Is there anything else about accessing healthcare in Rwanda that you think we should know?"
- "Thank you very much for your time and for sharing your experiences with us."

Interview script

Interview Script

This is one of the most important things you need to prepare.

The assignment specifically says:

- Don't ask only yes/no questions.
- Don't describe your solution before asking about the problem.
- Don't guess the answers.
- Record what real people actually tell you.

So the interview should focus on **their existing experience**, not on convincing them that your app is a good idea.

Healthcare Access User Interview

Opening — 2 minutes

Hello, thank you for taking the time to speak with us.

We are conducting research for our African Leadership University final project. We want to understand people's real experiences accessing healthcare, pharmacies, insurance, and emergency services in Rwanda.

There are no right or wrong answers. We are interested in your actual experiences.

Before we begin, do you agree to participate in this interview?

[Wait for answer]

Do you also agree to have this interview audio recorded for our academic research?

[Wait for answer]

Thank you. Let's begin.

Section 1: Background — 3 minutes

1. Can you briefly tell me about yourself and your experience living or working in Rwanda?
 2. How long have you been in Rwanda?
 3. What type of health insurance do you currently use, if any?
 4. Can you tell me about the last time you needed healthcare or medicine in Rwanda?
-

Section 2: Finding Healthcare — 5 minutes

5. When you need medicine or healthcare, how do you normally decide where to go?
 6. Can you walk me through what you did the last time you needed to find a pharmacy?
 7. How did you find out whether the pharmacy accepted your insurance?
 8. What was difficult or inconvenient about that process?
 9. Have you ever arrived at a pharmacy and discovered that it did not accept your insurance? What happened?
 10. What information would have helped you before going to the pharmacy?
-

Section 3: Emergency Healthcare — 3 minutes

11. If you or someone with you had a medical emergency in Rwanda, what would you do first?
 12. What emergency or ambulance number would you call?
 13. How did you learn that number?
 14. Have you ever called an ambulance or emergency service in Rwanda? If yes, can you describe what happened?
 15. What would make it easier for you to get help during a medical emergency?
-

Section 4: Pharmacies and Opening Hours — 3 minutes

16. How do you normally find out whether a pharmacy is open?
17. Have you ever needed a pharmacy outside normal working hours? Tell me about that experience.
18. What do you know about pharmacies that operate 24 hours in Kigali?

19. If you needed medicine late at night, how would you find a pharmacy that is open?
 20. What information would you want to know before travelling to that pharmacy?
-

Section 5: Closing — 2 minutes

21. What is the biggest challenge you have experienced when trying to access healthcare in Rwanda?
22. If you could change one thing about the process, what would you change?
23. Is there anything else about accessing healthcare or pharmacies in Rwanda that you think we should understand?

Thank you very much for your time. Your experience is very valuable to our research.

Questions you personally own

Questions you personally own

#	Open question	Ask who	Owner
1	What is the correct emergency/ambulance number , and how does calling one actually work?	Pharmacist, clinic reception	David
2	Which insurers do international students at ALU hold? Does the university provide cover?	ALU student affairs + 6 student interviews	Robert
3	Do over-the-counter items still need a prescription, or only insured treatment?	Pharmacists	Elie
4	Are there 24-hour pharmacies in Kigali, and how common?	Pharmacists, students	David
5	Do pharmacists know instantly which insurers they take, or check a list? Would they welcome being listed in an app?	Pharmacists	Elie

Interviewer briefing

Interviewer Briefing

Team, before we start the interviews, please follow these guidelines:

1. Start by confirming consent.
2. If the interview is recorded, confirm permission to record before recording.
3. Use the interview script.
4. Ask open-ended questions instead of yes/no questions.
5. Do not explain or promote our proposed app before understanding the participant's current problem.
6. Ask participants to describe real experiences, not what they think we want to hear.
7. Use follow-up questions such as "Can you tell me more about that?" and "What happened next?"
8. Do not invent or assume information.
9. Record important statements as accurately as possible.
10. After the interview, upload the audio, consent confirmation, and interview notes to the shared Drive.

Please let me know immediately if you cannot complete your assigned interview so we can reassign it.

Our target is to have all 12 interviews completed by **Saturday 19 September at midday.**

Links



**Healthcare Access in
Rwanda**



Screeners / Google Form

[Link](#)

<https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSf1fwixOjxEUawHh7JN74NWsPcZPkhragQR-SEh-4mEdZfFYw/viewform>

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSeKgyVINGdyN-7TnGvKt-uScsmvf02o1_d75FDDNb86sq9wbQ/formResponse

Interview booking tracker

[Link](#)

Interview - Script - Pharmacist

Pharmacist Interview Script

Opening — 2 minutes

Hello, thank you for taking the time to speak with us.

We are conducting research for our African Leadership University final project. We want to understand the experiences of pharmacists and pharmacies in Rwanda, particularly around customers finding medicines, insurance, pharmacy availability, and emergency or after-hours healthcare.

There are no right or wrong answers. We are interested in your actual experiences and challenges.

Before we begin, do you agree to participate in this interview?

[Wait for answer]

Do you also agree to have this interview audio recorded for our academic research?

[Wait for answer]

Thank you. Let's begin.

Section 1: Background & Pharmacy Experience — 3 minutes

1. Could you tell me a little about your role and your experience working as a pharmacist in Rwanda?
 2. What type of pharmacy do you currently work in, and what does a typical working day look like for you?
 3. What are the most common reasons customers come to your pharmacy?
 4. Can you walk me through what normally happens when a customer comes to your pharmacy looking for a particular medicine?
-

Section 2: Medicine Availability — 5 minutes

5. How do you currently keep track of the medicines that are available in your pharmacy?
 6. Can you tell me about a recent situation where a customer came looking for a medicine that you did not have? What happened?
 7. When you don't have a medicine a customer needs, what do you normally do?
 8. How do customers usually find out whether your pharmacy has a particular medicine before coming to the pharmacy?
 9. What challenges do you experience when customers are looking for medicines that are unavailable?
 10. Are there particular medicines or categories of medicines that are more difficult to keep available? Why?
 11. How do you communicate with suppliers or other pharmacies when you need to find a medicine that you don't have?
-

Section 3: Customers Finding Pharmacies — 4 minutes

12. How do new or existing customers usually find your pharmacy?
 13. What questions do customers commonly ask before coming to the pharmacy?
 14. Can you describe a situation where a customer had difficulty finding your pharmacy or reaching you?
 15. How do customers find out your opening and closing hours?
 16. How do you currently communicate changes in opening hours, temporary closures, or holiday schedules to customers?
 17. What information do you think customers often don't have before they travel to a pharmacy?
-

Section 4: Insurance & Payment — 4 minutes

18. What types of health insurance do you commonly deal with at your pharmacy?
19. Can you walk me through what happens when a customer wants to use insurance to purchase medicine?
20. What challenges do you or your customers experience when processing insurance?
21. Have you experienced situations where a customer believed their insurance would work at your pharmacy but it didn't? Can you describe what happened?

22. How do customers usually find out whether your pharmacy accepts their particular insurance?
 23. What information would make the insurance process easier for both pharmacists and customers?
-

Section 5: After-Hours & Emergency Situations — 4 minutes

24. Can you tell me about your experience dealing with customers who need medicine outside normal pharmacy hours?
 25. How do customers currently find pharmacies that are open late at night or 24 hours?
 26. What challenges do pharmacies face when providing services outside normal working hours?
 27. Have you ever had a customer come to your pharmacy during an urgent or emergency situation? What happened?
 28. When a customer needs something that your pharmacy cannot provide during an emergency, what do you normally do?
 29. What information do you think would be most useful to a person trying to find an available pharmacy during an emergency?
-

Section 6: Communication & Information — 3 minutes

30. How do you currently communicate with customers about medicine availability, pharmacy services, or important updates?
 31. What questions do customers repeatedly ask your staff that could potentially be answered before they visit the pharmacy?
 32. Are there situations where customers call or visit several pharmacies looking for the same medicine? Can you describe what usually happens?
 33. What information would you like customers to have before contacting or visiting your pharmacy?
-

Section 7: Challenges & Opportunities — 4 minutes

34. What is the biggest operational challenge you currently face in serving customers?

35. What is the biggest challenge your customers face when trying to get medicines from your pharmacy?
 36. If you could improve one part of how customers interact with your pharmacy, what would you change?
 37. What information or tools would make your work as a pharmacist easier?
 38. Have you tried any technology or digital systems to address these challenges? What was that experience like?
 39. What concerns would you have about using a new digital system in your pharmacy?
-

Closing — 2 minutes

40. Looking at the current healthcare and pharmacy system in Rwanda, what do you think is the biggest gap that affects patients trying to get medicines?
41. If you could change one thing about how pharmacies and patients interact, what would you change?
42. Is there anything about working in a pharmacy or serving patients in Rwanda that we haven't discussed but you think is important for us to understand?

Thank you very much for your time. Your experience and insights are very valuable to our research.

Diagrams - playground

1. Problem Statement (academic style)

Newcomers to Rwanda — including international students, expatriate professionals, and other recent arrivals — frequently carry health insurance issued by a foreign or unfamiliar provider. While the majority of pharmacies in Rwanda accept cash payment regardless of insurance affiliation, a subset of pharmacies additionally accept specific insurers, and this information is only made available through a physical notice — typically a board or sticker — displayed at the pharmacy's entrance. Consequently, this information, although factually public, is not accessible in any centralized, searchable, or remote form.

In practice, an individual seeking to determine whether a nearby pharmacy accepts their insurance has only two available methods: physically travelling to the pharmacy to read the posted notice, or contacting the insurance provider directly to request the information verbally. Both methods are time-inefficient, and neither scales to situations involving multiple pharmacies, unfamiliar neighbourhoods, or time-sensitive circumstances such as a medical emergency. This inefficiency is compounded for newcomers, who additionally lack local knowledge of pharmacy locations, operating hours, and emergency contact procedures.

This gap — between information that already exists publicly and the absence of any digital means to access it remotely — constitutes the central problem this project addresses. The proposed intervention does not seek to alter existing healthcare or insurance procedures, but rather to digitize an existing, verifiable source of public information (the pharmacy-door notice) into a searchable, location-aware mobile application, thereby reducing the time, uncertainty, and physical effort currently required to locate insurance-compatible healthcare providers.

2. Steps and Algorithm — How the App Performs in Use

User-facing steps (standard flow)

1. **Onboarding** — user opens the app and selects their insurance provider from a list (or enters "no insurance / cash only").
2. **Location access** — app requests the user's current location (or a manually entered area).
3. **Provider retrieval** — app queries its database for pharmacies and hospitals within a defined radius that are tagged as accepting the selected insurer.
4. **Filtering & sorting** — results are filtered by distance and "open now" status, and sorted nearest-first.
5. **Results display** — user sees a list/map of matching providers, each showing name, distance, open/closed status, and accepted insurers.

6. **Provider detail view** — user taps a result to see full address, hours, phone number, directions, and "what to bring" (e.g., insurance card, prescription, ID).
7. **Navigation handoff** — user taps "Directions" and is routed via a maps app or in-app routing.
8. **Emergency mode (parallel path)** — at any point, a persistent one-tap Emergency button lets the user skip all filtering and immediately see the nearest open provider plus the correct emergency number, with an option to call directly.

Based on your **problem statement, algorithm, pharmacist research, and the rubric**, the design instructions should make the IA, user flows, and storyboard tell **one consistent story**. The diagrams should reflect the actual problem you are solving: **helping newcomers remotely identify healthcare providers that match their insurance, availability, and location**.

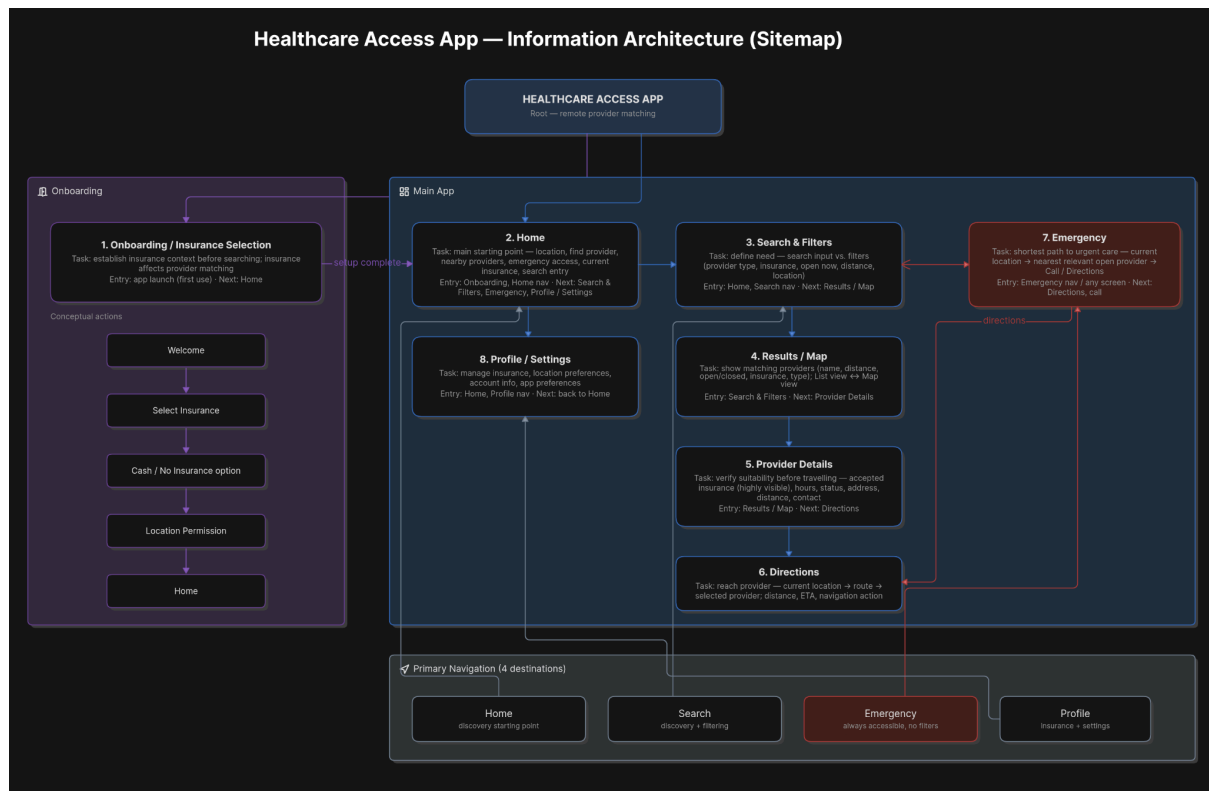
Below is a design-ready specification your team can use directly in Figma.

1. Information Architecture (IA)

Goal

Create an IA that shows how the app's information is organized and how a newcomer moves through the system.

The IA should contain **8 core screens** and keep the navigation simple. Do not create screens just to fill the requirement; each screen should support a real user task identified in the problem statement.



The 8 screens

#	Screen	Purpose
1	Onboarding / Insurance Selection	User identifies their insurance provider or selects cash/no insurance
2	Home	Main starting point with nearby healthcare options and core actions
3	Search / Filters	User searches by pharmacy/hospital, insurance, distance, open status
4	Results / Map	Displays matching providers based on location and filters

5	Provider Details	Shows address, distance, hours, phone, accepted insurers and relevant information
6	Directions	Provides the route/navigation handoff to the selected provider
7	Emergency	One-tap emergency pathway showing nearest relevant open provider and emergency contact
8	Profile / Settings	User manages insurance, location preferences and other account/app settings

Navigation principle

Keep the primary navigation focused:

Home

Search

Emergency

Profile

Avoid putting every feature into the navigation bar.

The **Emergency** action should be visually prominent and accessible without requiring the user to go through multiple screens.

IA design requirements

In Figma:

- Use **rectangles** for screens.
- Use **lines/arrows** to show relationships.
- Group screens according to major areas.
- Clearly identify the **main navigation**.
- Use consistent screen names between the IA and user-flow diagrams.
- Do not introduce features that aren't supported by your research.
- Show the hierarchy rather than detailed UI components.

2. User Flows

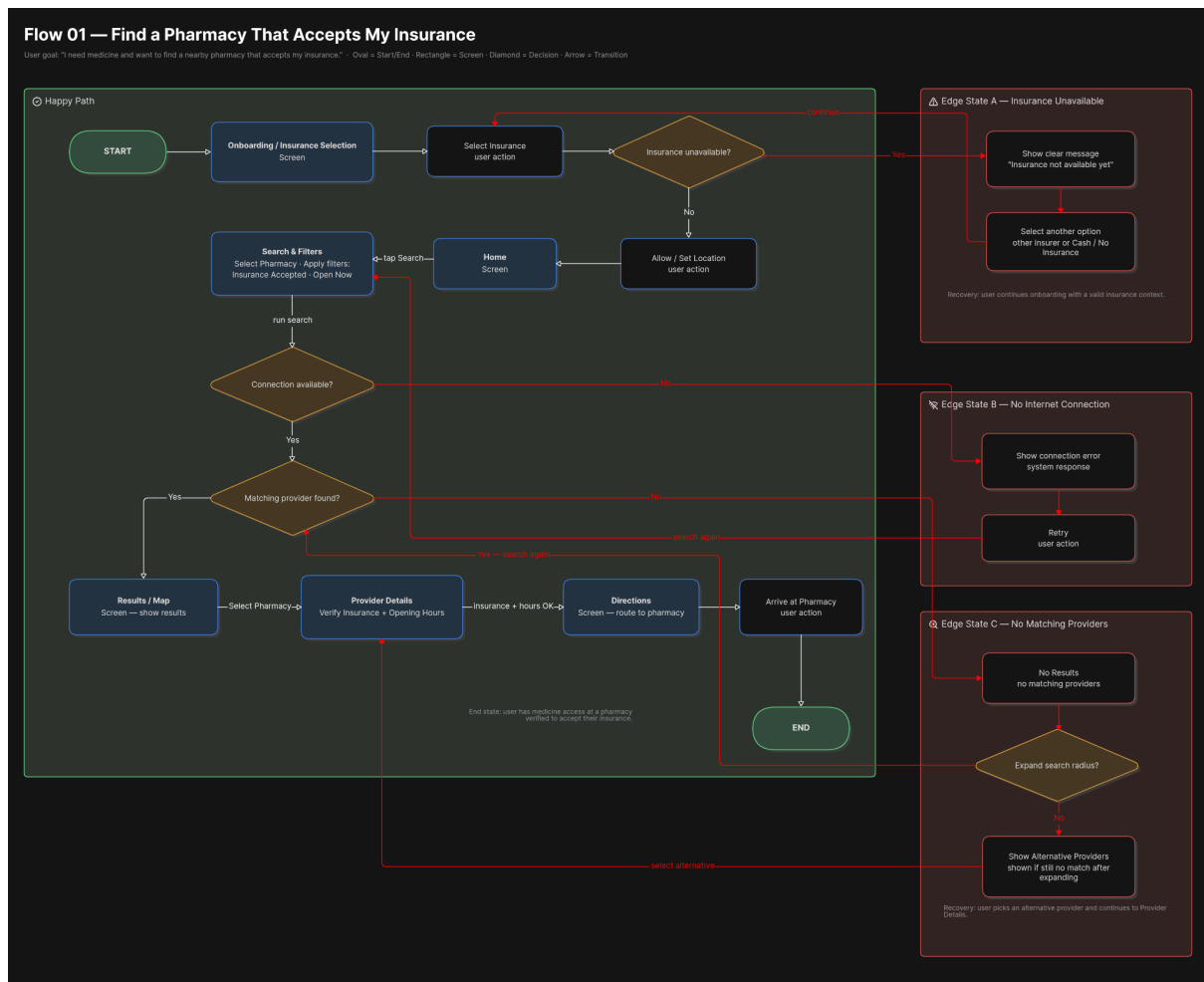
The rubric specifically asks for **happy paths and edge cases**, so don't create only one straight-line flow.

You should create **three core flows** because your app has three distinct user tasks.

Flow A — Find a pharmacy that accepts my insurance

User goal

"I need medicine and want to find a nearby pharmacy that accepts my insurance."

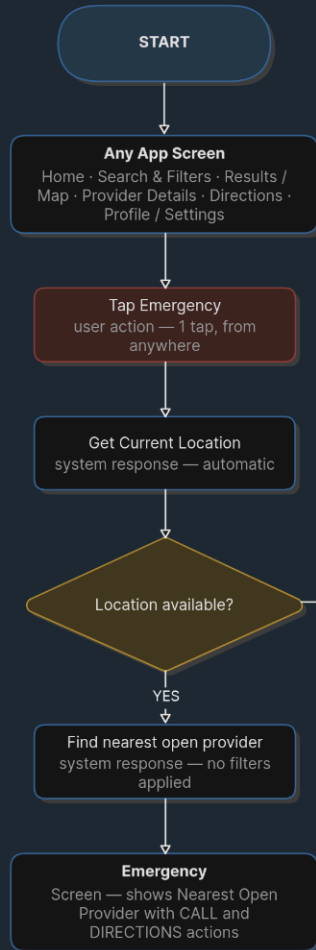


3. User Flow B — Emergency

Flow 02 — Emergency

User goal: "I need urgent healthcare right now." · Oval = Start/End · Rectangle = Screen · Diamond = Decision · Arrow = Transition · Small text = user action / system response

☉ Happy Path — minimum interactions

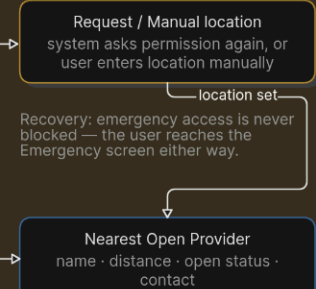


⚡ Critical design requirement

Minimal decisions, minimum interaction.
Only 2 decisions: location availability and
CALL vs DIRECTIONS.
Not required before urgent care:

- Insurance
- Search
- Filters
- Results
- Provider comparison

🚫 Edge State — Location Unavailable



Recovery: emergency access is never
blocked — the user reaches the
Emergency screen either way.

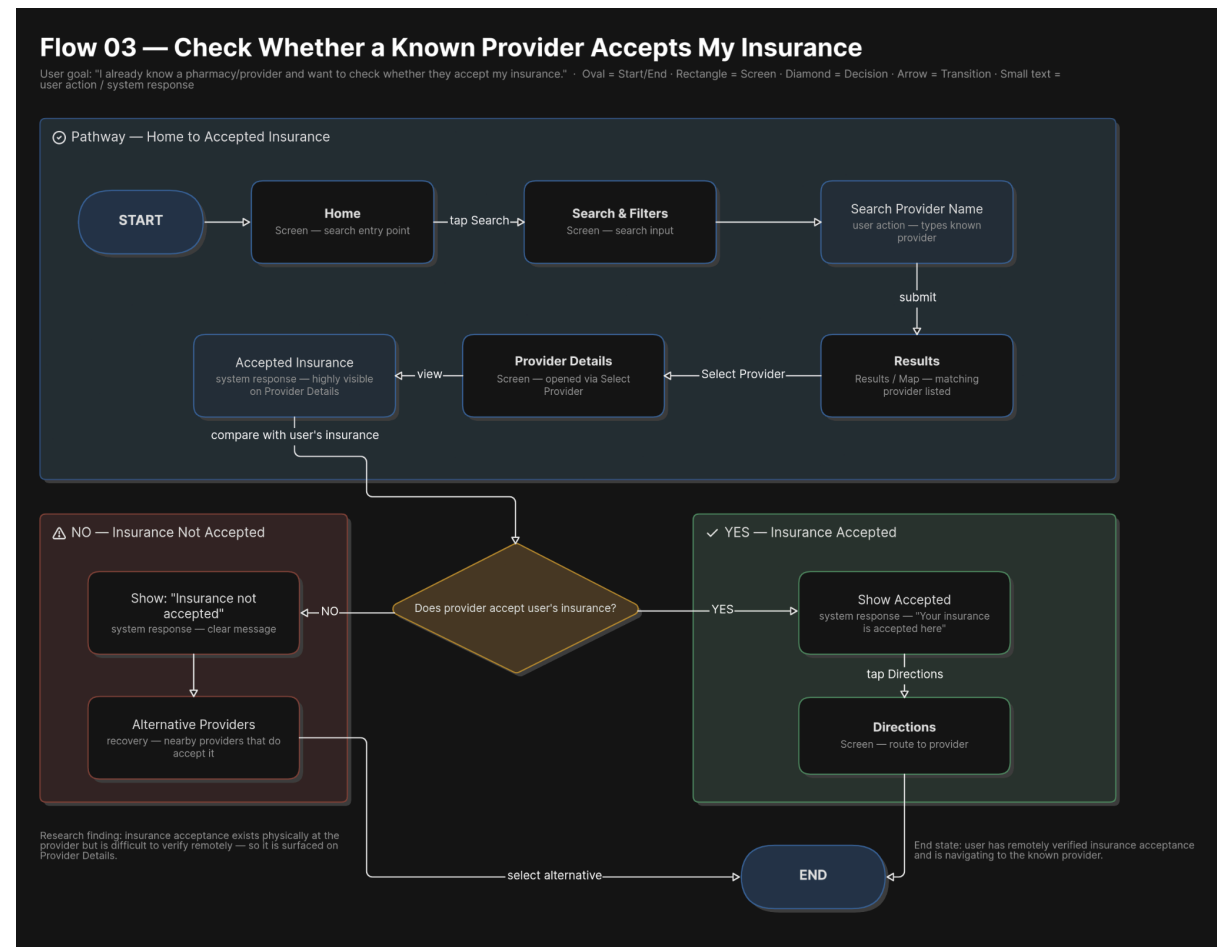
End state: user is connected to urgent care —
on a call with the provider, or navigating to the
nearest open provider.

4. User Flow C — Find out whether a provider accepts my insurance

This is slightly different from simply finding the nearest pharmacy.

User goal

"I already know about a pharmacy and want to know whether it accepts my insurance."



USER FLOW DIAGRAM



Figma Design

Figma Design